

Monday, 24 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Partly cloudy

22° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

22° 12°

MANCHESTER

Partly cloudy

21° 14°

GLASGOW

Overcast

22° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Mayors to get powers to overrule local councils on planning decisions.

Housing minister Matthew Pennycook said the change was "essential" for helping mayors "effectively deliver new homes".

UK · NEWS

2

Struggling households need more help with bills, energy industry says.

Industry body Energy UK says the current support for households most in need does not go far enough.

UK · NEWS

3

Restriction zone scheme for offenders to start in October.

Serious violent and sexual offenders may be confined to areas of just a few miles after leaving prison on probation.

UK · NEWS

4

CrossCountry cancels 'almost all' UK services after power cut.

Customers say the disruption to virtually all UK CrossCountry services is the "worst case scenario".

UK · NEWS

5

Scammers increasingly using QR codes to steal money and data.

Scammers set up a monthly subscription of £60 from Les Howard's account after he downloaded an app.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Davis 'grateful' for support over cancer diagnosis.**
The Office star was appearing at convention in London, less than two weeks after announcing her condition.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Drugs at their fingertips, intense pressure: Why child stars fall into addiction.**
Experts told the BBC the pressures of childhood stardom can put actors at an unusually higher risk of substance abuse issues.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Wicker Man director's sons complete their late father's film trilogy.**
The final film in the folk horror trilogy brings closure to the saga as well as its creator's family after more than 50 years.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Hidden museum gallery to reopen after 83 years.**
The gallery, which has been closed since 1943, will reopen from 16 September.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Blue plaque unveiled at home of Paddington creator.**
Chairman of the Haslemere Society, Chris Harrison, says it was a day where "friends were reunited".
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1** **Man City agree £86m deal for 18-year-old Bouaddi.**
Manchester City agree a deal in principle for 18-year-old Lille midfielder Ayyoub Bouaddi worth 100m euros (£86m).
SPORT · UK
- 2** **'New season, new trim' - Haaland reveals buzzcut.**
Manchester City striker Erling Haaland reveals his new buzz cut on social media.
SPORT · UK
- 3** **Golf brand apologises for advert that shows woman being pushed over.**
Content creator Good Good apologises and removes an advert that shows a woman being pushed to the ground as she reached for a man's golf club.
SPORT · UK
- 4** **Mourinho urges Vinicius Jr to control emotions.**
Jose Mourinho says Real Madrid's Brazil winger Vinicius Jr "needs to have great emotional control" when being bullied in games.
SPORT · UK
- 5** **Australia beat Bangladesh in two days.**
Mitchell Starc takes 10 wickets in the match as Australia bounce back to win the second Test against Bangladesh by an innings and 51 runs and draw the series.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

1 A study suggests that the simple act of 'waving hello' to neighbours can significantly boost community spirit and personal well-being.

Researchers found that even a small, friendly gesture can create a ripple effect, leading to stronger local connections and a greater sense of belonging amongst residents.

2 The surprising trend of 'indoor mini-gardens' is flourishing, with people transforming small spaces into vibrant green oases.

From herb gardens on windowsills to miniature succulent displays, these tiny patches of nature are bringing a touch of the outdoors inside, even for those without a big garden.

3 Scientists have discovered that the smell of 'freshly baked bread' can genuinely make people feel more generous and helpful.

Apparently, the comforting aroma triggers a positive emotional response, making us more inclined to offer assistance to others or contribute to good causes.

4 A new report highlights a delightful surge in 'intergenerational book clubs', where grandparents and grandchildren share stories.

These clubs are fostering wonderful connections, allowing different generations to bond over literature and share perspectives on classic tales and new releases.

5 The enduring appeal of 'traditional board games' is seeing a fresh revival, with families rediscovering the joy of unplugged fun.

Away from screens, games like Monopoly, Scrabble, and Cluedo are bringing families together for laughter and friendly competition on rainy afternoons.

6 Research indicates that 'watching clouds drift by' can be a surprisingly effective way to reduce stress and boost creativity.

Taking a few moments to observe the changing shapes in the sky encourages mindfulness and can help clear the mind, opening it up to new ideas.

7 The charming habit of 'leaving anonymous notes of kindness' in public places is gaining traction across the UK.

People are leaving uplifting messages on park benches, library books, or in cafes, spreading positivity and brightening strangers' days with unexpected words of encouragement.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new piece of fruit is ripe enough, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE SNIFF!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of tea or coffee, especially when it's a new mug. What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE INSIDE OF THE MUG A LITTLE TAP OR TWO WITH A SPOON.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you discover a 'clever little shortcut' in your daily routine that saves you time or effort, and you wonder how you ever managed without it?**

What's that one brilliant, simple hack you've incorporated into your day that just makes life a tiny bit easier? Perhaps it's a unique way to organise your keys, or a speedy method for folding laundry? We'd love to hear your ingenious little time-savers!

- **We all have those 'childhood games or pastimes' that instantly transport us back to simpler times, don't we?**

What was your absolute favourite game to play as a child, perhaps in the garden, at school, or with your friends? Was it hopscotch, building dens, or something entirely unique to your street? Call in and share those lovely nostalgic memories!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of pugs is actually called a 'grumble'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of magpies is actually called a 'chatter'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's oldest known living tree, 'Methuselah', is a Great Basin bristlecone pine located in the White Mountains of California and is over 4,800 years old.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- The tiny 'pocket' on a pair of jeans was originally designed for a pocket watch.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.
- A single cloud can weigh more than a million pounds, or about 450,000 kilograms.

On this day

Day 236 of the year, 129 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aurea of Ostia; Christian feast day: Bartholomew the Apostle (Roman Catholic, Anglican); Christian feast day: Edward Klinik; Christian feast day: Emily de Vialar. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1957 — Stephen Fry, English actor, journalist, producer, and screenwriter
- 1945 — Ronee Blakley, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1995 — Lady Amelia Windsor, member of the British royal family
- 1940 — Madsen Pirie, British academic, President and co-founder of the Adam Smith Institute
- 1988 — Rupert Grint, English actor
- 1942 — Jimmy Soul, American pop-soul singer (died 1988)
- 1938 — David Freiberg, American singer and bass player
- 1961 — Jared Harris, English actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1989 — Colombian drug barons declare "total war" on the Colombian government.
- 2020 — Erin O'Toole is elected leader of the Conservative Party of Canada.
- 2023 — Japan officially begins discharging treated radioactive water from the Fukushima Daiichi Nuclear Power Plant into the Pacific Ocean, sparking international concerns and condemnation.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1995 — Microsoft releases Windows 95 to the public in North America.
- 2004 — Ninety passengers die after two airliners explode after flying out of Domodedovo International Airport, near Moscow. The explosions are caused by suicide bombers from Chechnya.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2010 — Agni Air Flight 101 crashes near Shikharpur, Makwanpur, Nepal, killing all 14 people on board.
- 1981 — Mark David Chapman is sentenced to 20 years to life in prison for murdering John Lennon.
- 1989 — Colombian drug barons declare "total war" on the Colombian government.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 237 of the year, 128 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Æbbe of Coldingham; Christian feast day: Aredius; Christian feast day: Genesisius of Arles; Christian feast day: Genesisius of Rome. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1963 — Shock G, American rapper and producer (died 2021)
- 1949 — Gene Simmons, Israeli-American singer-songwriter, producer, and actor
- 1970 — Jo Dee Messina, American singer-songwriter
- 1978 — Kel Mitchell, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1977 — Jonathan Togo, American actor
- 1968 — Spider One, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1969 — Catriona Matthew, Scottish golfer
- 1961 — Ally Walker, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1967 — George Lincoln Rockwell, founder of the American Nazi Party, is assassinated by a former member of his group.
- 1991 — Linus Torvalds announces the first version of what will become Linux.
- 2001 — American singer Aaliyah and several members of her entourage are killed as their overloaded aircraft crashes shortly after takeoff from Marsh Harbour Airport, Bahamas.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2010 — A Filair Let L-410 Turbolet crashes on approach to Bandundu Airport, killing 20.
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Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar